

## YOUR COURT HEARING SCRIPT

This script helps you speak to the judge. You can bring this paper with you.

**WHEN YOUR CASE IS CALLED:** Walk to the front.

**You:** Good morning/afternoon, Your Honor. My name is Sarah O. Connelly.

**Judge:** Do you have an attorney?

**You:** No, Your Honor. I am representing myself.

**Judge:** Have you filed your Answer?

**You:** Yes, Your Honor. Here is a copy. (hand judge copy)

**Judge:** Do you owe the rent?

**You:** I dispute the amount claimed OR Yes, and I deposited it with the court.

**EXPLAIN YOUR DEFENSE:** Tell the judge briefly why you should not be evicted.

Examples: Landlord refused repairs / Retaliation / Improper notice / Already paid

**IF YOU NEED MORE TIME:**

**You:** Your Honor, I request more time to find housing or make arrangements.

**CLOSING:** Thank you for hearing me, Your Honor.

**TIPS:** Dress neatly. No phone. Do not interrupt. Bring all documents.